T.P.E.E.R. Proposal

Proposed by Vigneshwaran S P (Vicky), B.E. Computer Science, BIT Sathy

T.P.E.E.R. (Think, Plan, Explain, Execute, Review) is a five-stage loop for building small software projects. This proposal asks teams to try it on one project for four weeks and compare the results with how they work today.

The problem

Small teams often go straight from an idea to code. Misunderstandings show up after the build, and nobody compares the result with a goal that was set beforehand.

T.P.E.E.R. adds two cheap checkpoints. Explain the plan out loud before building, and review the result against a target afterward.

The method

Each stage has one question, one output and one test for moving on. Review loops back to Think, so there is no separate repeat stage.

Stage	Question	Output	Exit test
Think	What problem are we solving, and for whom?	One-sentence problem statement and constraints	Someone else can repeat the problem back correctly
Plan	What is the smallest path that could work, and how will we know?	Short step list and one measurable success criterion	The criterion is a number, a behavior or a yes/no
Explain	Does anyone else get it, and does it still make sense out loud?	A two-minute explanation to a peer or user	No gaps found, or gaps fixed by returning to Plan
Execute	Can we build the smallest version that tests the plan?	A working slice, not the whole product	It runs end to end, even if roughly
Review	Did it meet the criterion, and what did we learn?	Result against target, plus one keep, one drop, one change	The next loop's problem statement can be named

Five rules

1. **Explain gate.** If you cannot explain the plan in two minutes, go back to Plan, not forward to Execute.
2. **Right-size the loop.** A bug fix is a five-minute loop and a product is a multi-week loop. The stages stay the same.

3. **Cap the loops.** After three loops without meeting the success criterion, return to Think. The problem is probably wrong, not the solution.
4. **Fix the target first.** The success criterion from Plan is the only judge in Review, and it does not move afterward.
5. **Stopping is allowed.** Review can end a project. That counts as a valid result of the cycle.

Proposed pilot

Run T.P.E.E.R. on one project per team for four weeks. Record the same four measures before and during the pilot so the comparison is fair.

Measure	How to record it
Rework after review	Count of items sent back to Plan or Think
Time to first working slice	Days from Think to the first Execute output
Loops to meet the criterion	Number of full cycles per feature
Team confidence	1 to 5 rating from each member at the end of each week

These measures and the four-week length are proposals. Change them if the team's project calls for something else.

Decision requested

[ ] Agree to a four-week pilot

[ ] Choose one project to run it on

[ ] Name one person to keep the stage notes

[ ] Book a review meeting at the end of week four